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Student Activities

Policy

This policy establishes systemwide policies, procedures, and guidelines for student organizations and activities. All provisions in this policy are expected to be implemented by the 2023-2024 academic year. Campuses are authorized to set earlier implementation time lines for any of the provisions.

Student Organizations

Student organizations comprise a vital part of the college student experience and can contribute to student success and engagement. Participation in student organizations affords students the opportunity to develop organizational and leadership skills, foster capacities for effective teamwork, and promote civic engagement and community service, while connecting with peers, faculty and staff.

A campus' recognition of a student organization in accordance with the policy or administration of funds generated by the student organization does not express or signify that the campus approves or endorses the organization's goals, activities, or points of view, or that the campus supervises or otherwise controls the student organization or its activities. Nevertheless, and provided that a student organization meets and maintains campus requirements for recognition, campuses provide to student organizations certain benefits and privileges (e.g., use of designated on-campus facilities free of charge, funding opportunities, support for on-campus program planning, and information regarding basic event management and financial management practices).

Campuses shall establish and publish procedures for formal chartering and recognition of student organizations in compliance with the following policies:

Formal Chartering and Recognition Policies

Campuses shall comply with all student organization filing requirements described in California Code of Regulations, Title 5, Article 4, Nondiscrimination in Student Organizations, Sections 41500 (*Withholding of Recognition*), 41501 (*Definition of Recognition*), 41503 (*Filing Requisites*), and 41504 (*Penalties*). These sections require each student organization to deposit with the vice president of student affairs or designee copies of all constitutions, charters, or other documents relating to its policies. Documents shall be refiled within 90 days after any substantive change or amendment.

No campus shall recognize any fraternity, sorority, honor society, or other student organization that discriminates on the basis of race or ethnicity (including color, caste, and ancestry), religion (or religious creed), nationality, citizenship, age, medical condition, genetic information, gender (or sex), gender identity (including nonbinary or transgender), gender expression, sexual orientation, marital status, veteran or military status, or disability (physical or mental) (hereafter referred to as the nondiscrimination statement). Student organizations shall deliver to the vice president for student affairs or designee a statement signed by the president or similar officer of the local student organization attesting that the organization has no rules or policies that discriminate on the basis of the nondiscrimination statement. The student organization statement shall be renewed annually.

No campus shall recognize any student organization unless its membership and leadership are open to all currently enrolled students at that campus, with the limited exception that a social fraternity or sorority may impose a gender limitation as permitted by Education Code Section 66273. Student organizations may require applicants for leadership positions to have been members for a specified period of time, and may require officers to compete for those positions in elections of the membership.

In recognizing student organizations, campuses are encouraged to consider such factors as the mix of students who reside on campus, students who commute, part-time and full-time students, students who are working while attending college, and other factors that will provide opportunities that meet the diverse needs of students seeking to affiliate with student organizations.

Role of Auxiliary Organizations in Recognizing Student Organizations

Campuses may not delegate to an auxiliary organization the process of recognizing or approving student organizations. Nor may auxiliary organizations manage, control or supervise student organizations or their activities. Auxiliary organizations also may not provide auxiliary funds or facilities free of charge to student organizations that are not currently recognized by the campus. Funding (e.g., campus, Associated Students and student union) and use of facilities free of charge are available only to student organizations that are currently recognized by the campus.

University Sponsored Organizations for Student Organizations Affiliated with National Scholastic Honor Societies

The campus may sponsor student clubs or organizations affiliated with a national scholastic honor society under the category University Sponsored Organizations. University Sponsored Organizations, unlike student organizations, invites members on the basis of scholastic achievement and may require skill-based, aptitude test requirements such as a minimum grade point average, academic discipline, unit requirements or classification (description as upper division, lower division, graduate student, etc.). University Sponsored Organizations must comply with all CSU systemwide policies, procedures and guidelines in accordance with this policy.

It is the responsibility of the sponsoring Advisor or Department to complete all the requirements for chartering and recognition from the campus. Formally chartered and recognized University Sponsored Organizations will be afforded all benefits and opportunities as provided to recognized student organizations. Membership may be defined by the affiliation with the national scholastic honor society; however, no students in University Sponsored Organizations can be denied membership on the basis of the nondiscrimination statement.

Withholding and Withdrawing Official Recognition

Official recognition of student organizations that fail to abide by the open membership policy or that discriminate on the basis of the nondiscrimination statement shall be withdrawn.

In addition, official recognition of a student organization may be withdrawn for hazing or conspiracy to haze as defined in the California Code of Regulations, Title 5, *Standards for Student Conduct*, Section 41301(b)(8). Individual students may be disciplined for hazing under Section 41301(b)(8).

Campuses shall establish standards for recognized student organizations and procedures for imposing consequences for organizations found to be in violation of these standards. Consequences are intended to be educational in nature and may include, but are not limited to, withdrawal of recognition, suspension of recognition for a specified period of time, probation (warning that might lead to a more severe consequence), restriction of privileges, reprimand, and restitution for losses caused. Further, campuses may stipulate conditions on how a student organization regains recognition.

Minimum Number of Students

Official recognition of a student organization requires a minimum of five CSU students who are currently enrolled in at least one class. Given the educational purpose of student organizations in the higher education setting, members of a student organization must be enrolled as a CSU student. Only students enrolled at the CSU campus may vote on issues that come before the student organization.

In cases where an educational need is met, the vice president for student affairs (or Senior Student Affairs Officer) or designee may waive the membership provisions for student organizations. In these instances, non-CSU members shall not comprise more than 20% of the student organization's total

membership. Documentation for this waiver shall include copies of national charters or other appropriate documentation, and these documents shall be submitted to the vice president of student affairs or designee.

Campuses retain authority to include additional requirements for recognition and/or to make the requirements listed here more limiting.

Minimum Qualifications for Student Office Holders

While the co-curricular learning opportunities afforded by student involvement and leadership experiences are valuable, students' academic pursuits are still primary, and student office holders and systemwide committee appointees have an obligation to demonstrate academic involvement, achievement, and progress. This is also important given the representative, fiduciary, legal, and other long-range policy-making responsibilities and influence of student office holders,

All student representatives, candidates, and incumbents for major and minor office positions must be matriculated at a CSU campus maintaining a minimum campus term grade point average (GPA) of 2.0, are in good standing, and must not be on academic, disciplinary or administrative probation. This requirement applies to the major student government offices defined below, minor student representative offices as defined by the campus, and student representatives to systemwide committees.

These requirements are minimum qualifications. The vice president for student affairs or designee is authorized to increase the minimum qualifications, including the term GPA and cumulative GPA, and establish additional requirements as determined by the campus.

Major Student Government Offices

Major student offices include students who are executive officers or board members on student government; students who serve on campus auxiliary organizations boards (e.g., student unions, recreation centers, foundations and commercial enterprises); and students who are officers or board members of California State Student Association (CSSA).

Candidate Requirements

A. Candidate Unit Load

Undergraduate candidates must maintain 6 semester (9 quarter) units per term while running for office. Graduate and credential student candidates must maintain 3 semester (4 quarter) units per term while running for office.

B. Candidate Residency

Undergraduate candidates for office must have been enrolled on the campus and have completed at least one semester or two quarters prior to the election, earning a minimum of 6 semester (9 quarter) units during that year. Graduate and credential candidates must be currently enrolled on the campus in a minimum of 3 semester (4 quarter) units per term to be eligible.

Year-round quarter campuses may establish a lower number of quarter units that new graduate and credential students must earn to fulfill candidate residency requirements for major student government offices.

Incumbent Requirements

A. Incumbent Unit Load

Undergraduate students must earn 6 semester (9 quarter) units of credit per term while holding office. Graduate and credential students must earn 3 semester (4 quarter) units of credit per term while holding office.

Students enrolled at quarter campuses must attend a minimum of two quarters during the academic year to maintain eligibility. However, year-round quarter campuses may require student office holders to be enrolled a minimum of three quarters during the calendar year to maintain eligibility.

B. Incumbent Maximum Allowable Units

Undergraduate students are allowed to earn a maximum of 150 semester (225 quarter) units or 125 percent of the units required for a specific baccalaureate degree objective, whichever is greater.

Graduate and credential students are allowed to earn a maximum of 50 semester (75 quarter) units or 167 percent of the units required for the graduate or credential objective, whichever is greater. Students holding more than this number of units are not eligible for major student government office.

Minor Representative Officers

CSU student presidents and treasurers of campus-approved student clubs and organizations shall be defined as minor representative student officers. The vice president for student affairs or designee retains the authority to define additional minor representative officers as appropriate.

Candidate Requirements

Requirements regarding unit candidate unit load and candidate residency are determined by the vice president for student affairs or designee.

Incumbent Requirements

A. Incumbent Unit Load

Undergraduate incumbents must earn 6 semester (9 quarter) units per term while holding office. Graduate and credential incumbents must earn 3 semester (4 quarter) units per term while holding office.

Students enrolled at quarter campuses must attend a minimum of two quarters during the academic year to maintain eligibility.

B. Incumbent Maximum Allowable Units

Undergraduate students are allowed to earn a maximum of 150 semester (225 quarter) units or 125 percent of the units required for a specific baccalaureate degree objective, whichever is greater.

Graduate and credential students are allowed to earn a maximum of 50 semester (75 quarter) units or 167 percent of the units required for the graduate or credential objective, whichever is greater. Students

holding more than this number of units are not eligible for minor student representative office.

Systemwide Committee Appointees

All students who are appointed by the CSU to serve on regular or ad hoc systemwide committees must meet the following criteria.

Candidate Requirements

A. Candidate Unit Load

Undergraduate candidates must be enrolled in 6 semester (9 quarter) units per term while seeking appointment. Graduate and credential student candidates must be enrolled in 3 semester (4 quarter) units per term while seeking appointment.

B. Candidate Residency

Undergraduate nominees for systemwide committee appointment must have been enrolled in the CSU system and have completed one semester (two quarters) prior to the appointment, earning a minimum of 6 semester (9 quarter) units during that year. Graduate and credential candidates must be currently enrolled on the campus in a minimum of 3 semester (4 quarter) units per term to be eligible.

A. Incumbent Unit Load

Undergraduate students must earn a minimum of 6 semester (9 quarter) units per term while serving on a committee. Graduate and credential students must earn a minimum of 3 semester (4 quarter) units per term while serving.

Students at quarter campuses must attend a minimum of two quarters during the academic year to maintain eligibility.

B. Incumbent Maximum Allowable Units

Undergraduate students are allowed to earn a maximum of 150 semester (225 quarter) units or 125 percent of the units required for a specific baccalaureate degree objective, whichever is greater. Graduate and credential students are allowed to earn a maximum of 50 semester (75 quarter) units or 167 percent of the units required for the graduate or credential objective, whichever is greater. Students holding over that number of units will no longer be eligible to participate on systemwide committees.

Exceptions

Under extraordinary circumstances the vice president for student affairs or designee may make an exception to the requirements for unit load, maximum allowable units, residency, and GPA.

Student Organization Advisors

Each officially recognized student organization must have a university advisor who is either a faculty member or professional staff member who is an employee of the CSU or one of its auxiliaries.

Campuses may permit part-time faculty and professional staff to serve as advisors. The VPSA or designee may remove an advisor from their student organization-related responsibilities as needed to ensure that the educational purpose of student organizations is met, or in the interests of student health, safety and welfare. Campuses should develop a training and orientation program for university advisors

to student organizations.

Role of the Advisors

Advisors take on different responsibilities depending on the needs of their organization. It is important to remember that an advisor is not an administrator, executive officer or leader of the organization. Some common roles of the advisors are as a mentor, team builder, motivator, role model, educator, institutional policy interpreter, source of information and ideas, and liaison between the organization and university administration.

The duties and expectations of an advisor include maintaining regular contact and involvement with the officers of their student organizations, being knowledgeable about the missions, goals, and purpose of the student organization, helping the group understand the university's policies and guidelines, being familiar and involved with activities and events of the group, and being available to provide resources and support for events and usage of spaces, and to consult with respect to the administration of the financial affairs of the group in general.

As determined by the campus Clery Director and the Vice President for Student Affairs or designee, the advisor may also need to fulfill responsibilities as a Campus Security Authority in accordance with requirements outlined in CSU policy, [Implementation of the Jeanne Clery Disclosure of Campus Security Policy and Campus Crime Statistics Act \(the "Clery Act"\)](#). Advisors should consult with the campus Clery Director and/or Title IX Coordinator for additional information.

Training/Orientation Programs

The CSU Alcohol Policies and Prevention Program (Board Resolution REP 07-01-03) requires campuses to provide orientation programs for student organization advisors and for student officers that outline policies, expectations, and information on alcohol use/abuse. This orientation may be provided to advisors and officers of student organizations in writing or electronically. An acknowledgement of completion of this orientation that includes the name of the student organization and student officer(s) shall be retained by the vice president of student affairs or designee.

In addition, campuses shall advise student organizations and student officers about the California State University Student Conduct Code in Title 5, California Code of Regulations, Section 41301.

Members of Student Organizations Off-Campus Conduct

Campuses shall comply with Section 41301, *Standards for Student Conduct*, of Title 5 of the California Code of Regulations. This section clarifies the university's authority for off-campus behavior that includes students who are members of clubs and organizations. The Student Conduct Code sets the standard of expected behavior and describes conduct that is unacceptable and subject to discipline through the university's disciplinary process.

Club Sports Insurance

Officially recognized student club sports at all CSU campuses must carry adequate liability and

secondary medical insurance as determined in collaboration with the campus risk managers or the Office of Risk Management in the Chancellor's Office for all participants and coaches, including non-students and volunteers. The insurance shall cover travel, practices, and competition. Each campus may develop its own method for insurance coverage requiring participants to pay or other fiscally sound approaches as authorized by the campus vice president for student affairs or his/her designee. In no case may a campus utilize state appropriations to pay for club sports insurance. No student, non-student, or volunteer may participate in a club sport without approved insurance, and no club may be recognized or organized to participate in practices, competition, or travel without approved insurance.

Insurance documents should include appropriate hold harmless provisions as follows: "Insured shall hold harmless, indemnify, and defend the state of California, the Trustees of the California State University, the (*campus*) and the officers, employees, volunteers and agents of each of them from and against any and all liability, loss, damage, expense, costs of every nature, and causes of actions arising out of or in connection with the use by the insured of said property or participation in said activity."

Authority

This policy is issued pursuant to [Section II of the Standing Orders of the Board of Trustees of the California State University](#), and as further delegated by the [Standing Delegations of Administrative Authority](#).

All Revision Dates

11/15/2022, 12/21/2011

Approval Signatures

Step Description	Approver	Date
EVC	Sylvia Alva: EVC Acad/Stdnt Affairs [NE]	11/15/2022
Area Manager/Owner	Christina Gutierrez: Comm Spclst, Acad & Sdnt Affrs	11/15/2022
Area Manager/Owner	Ray Murillo: Dir, Student Affairs Programs	11/15/2022